

How to Appeal a Rejected PIP Claim for Arthritis

Practical NHS-backed advice on how to appeal a rejected pip claim for arthritis.

By **Living With Arthritis UK** · Reviewed by **Louis Maxwell** (HCPC Registered Physiotherapist) · 2026-07-24 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

How to Appeal a Rejected PIP Claim for Arthritis

Quick Answer: If your PIP claim is rejected, first request a Mandatory Reconsideration (MR) within one calendar month of the decision letter. If still refused, appeal to an independent tribunal. Around 68% of tribunal appeals are currently successful — don't give up after a first refusal.

A rejected PIP claim is not the end. The majority of people who appeal eventually receive PIP. Understanding the process and getting free support significantly improves your chances.

Step 1: Mandatory Reconsideration

Request an MR within one calendar month of your decision date by calling the PIP centre (0800 121 4433) or writing. Ask specifically for a copy of your assessment report and the assessor's notes. Be specific about which activities you disagree with and provide examples of how arthritis affects each one on your worst days.

What to Include

- Your NI number and claim reference
 - Specific activities you disagree with
 - Examples of how arthritis affects each activity on your worst days
 - New medical evidence from your GP or rheumatologist
 - Time taken to complete activities (much longer than normal scores points)
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Step 2: Tribunal Appeal



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If the MR is unsuccessful, appeal to the Social Security and Child Support Tribunal within one month. This is free and independent of the DWP. Around 68% of PIP tribunal appeals are currently won by the appellant.

Get Free Support

Never go to tribunal without support if possible. Citizens Advice (0800 144 8848), local Law Centres, and welfare rights units all provide free representation and significantly improve success rates.

Q&A;



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Question: How long does a PIP appeal take? **Short answer:** Mandatory Reconsideration typically takes 2–8 weeks. Tribunal appeals currently take 6–18 months. Continue receiving any existing benefits while waiting.

Question: Should I mention mental health effects of arthritis? **Short answer:** Yes — anxiety, depression, and cognitive effects of chronic pain all count toward PIP scoring. Include these alongside physical limitations.

Question: Do I need a solicitor for a PIP tribunal? **Short answer:** No — most claimants use free welfare rights advisors. However, having any representation significantly improves success rates.